(USDA) to alter the image of military control of the state and with a view to it functioning as a ruling political party (Taylor 2009, pp. 446–47). In 2010, the regime disbanded the USDA and transferred its members and assets to a newly registered political party, the USDP, which contested and won the general election later that year in the absence of the NLD. The USDP is therefore the incarnation of the regime after 2010 without the military uniform.

8 According to KRSAN staff, Pa-O youth who attended the capacity-building programme organized by Myanmar Egress usually returned believing the government would gradually move towards democracy (interview, 10 August 2014). Similarly, one 88 Generation leader said that Egress "accepts the 2008 Constitution when other democratic parties (are) against" it (interview, 10 August 2014). For more on the MPC, see Su Mon Thazin Aung, this volume.

9 The UPNO arrived late on the scene and is pro-democracy, hence it is not a suitable candidate for co-optation.

10 The PNLO is classified as neutral because it is neither pro-regime nor pro-democracy. Likewise, Myanmar Egress and the MPC have been classified as neutral, although they have been criticized as pro-regime due to having senior government officials on their boards of directors.

11 Interview, 8 August 2014.

12 The group appears to be very well funded, as they have nine full time staff occupying two detached houses.

13 The mine unearthed the world's largest jade boulder in 2001. Nay Win Tun donated the find to the military.

14 In 1995 when representing the Myanmar Fund, which had just completed a deal to build the Traders Hotel (name changed to Shangri-la in 2014) in Yangon, I was told by the Director General of the Directorate of Hotels and Tourism Lieutenant Colonel Khin Maung Latt that it was impossible to get a permit to build hotels at Lake Inle because of an issue concerning the land there. This was the time when Western sanctions were in full swing and the country badly needed foreign investment. Despite the Shangri-la group being much more qualified for a hotel project at Lake Inle, the PNO obtained permission to build hotels instead. The land issue was an excuse, because according to the person in charge of the Golden Island, the government owned all the land in the lake area (interview, 9 January 2015, Yangon).

15 Interview with the chairman of the PNO, Khun San Lwin, 27 August 2014.

16 Interview with a director of the PNLO, 8 August 2014.

17 I was a participant observer in the class on 10 August 2014.

18 Interview with KRSAN, 14 January 2015.

19 Interview with PNLO, 24 March 2015. The incident was reported in *The Irrawaddy*, 11 September 2014 <http://www.irrawaddy.org/burma/pa-o-shan-rebels-meet-clash-territory.html>. Accessed 26 April, 2015.